

ASSET MANAGEMENT POLICY

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Revision History

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1	1.0	16-Dec-2022	Initial	Kalpana J	Gayathri

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Asset Management Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Asset Management Policy is to establish clear guidelines and procedures for managing and safeguarding the physical and digital assets of the organization. This policy aims to ensure that assets are acquired, used, maintained, and disposed of in an efficient, cost-effective, and secure manner, while complying with legal and regulatory requirements.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all physical and digital assets owned, leased, or otherwise controlled by the organization. This includes assets used by employees, contractors, and third parties who may have access to company assets.

3. Asset Classification

To ensure that assets are managed effectively, they will be classified into the following categories:

3.1. Physical Assets:

- Office Equipment: Computers, printers, mobile devices, servers, office furniture, etc.
- Network Infrastructure: Routers, switches, firewalls, network cables, wireless access points, etc.
- Tools and Software: Development tools, licenses, and any other hardware or software used for operational or project purposes.
- Vehicles (if applicable): Any vehicles owned or leased by the organization for business purposes.

3.2. Digital Assets:

- Intellectual Property (IP): Software code, design documents, proprietary algorithms, patents, trademarks, copyrights, etc.
- Data and Databases: Databases, backups, customer data, financial records, and any other digital information critical to business operations.
- Licenses and Subscriptions: Software licenses, cloud services, external tools, and other digital service subscriptions.
- Emails and Accounts: Corporate email accounts, project management tools, cloud storage accounts, and any other accounts used for business purposes.

4. Asset Acquisition and Allocation

- Approval Process: All asset acquisitions (whether physical or digital) must be approved by the designated department head and the finance department. A formal request should be submitted and evaluated based on necessity and budget availability.
- Asset Register: Once an asset is acquired, it must be recorded in the company's Asset Register. The asset register will include details such as asset description, category, serial number, purchase date, location, assigned user, and expected lifecycle.
- Allocation and Assignment: All assets must be allocated and assigned to specific users or departments. An asset custodian (usually the department head or manager) will be responsible for

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ensuring that assets are utilized appropriately and securely.

5. Asset Usage and Security

- **Authorized Use:** Assets must only be used for business-related purposes. Any personal use of company assets (e.g., mobile phones, laptops) must be explicitly authorized by management.
- **Security Measures:** All assets must be protected from theft, damage, and unauthorized access. Employees must follow the organization's security protocols, such as setting up strong passwords, enabling encryption, and ensuring physical security (e.g., locking devices when not in use).
- **Data Security:** Digital assets containing sensitive or proprietary data (e.g., customer information, source code, etc.) must be secured with encryption, multi-factor authentication (MFA), and other relevant security controls.
- **Tracking and Monitoring:** The IT department will periodically monitor and track the location and condition of high-value or sensitive assets. This will include using asset management software or a manual log, where applicable.

6. Maintenance and Lifecycle Management

- **Regular Maintenance:** Assets, especially physical ones like servers, workstations, and mobile devices, must undergo regular maintenance and software updates to ensure optimal performance and security.
- **Warranty and Support:** The organization will maintain a record of warranties, service contracts, and support agreements for each asset to ensure timely maintenance and replacement when necessary.
- **Depreciation and Amortization:** Assets will be depreciated according to their expected useful life and in accordance with relevant accounting standards.
- **Asset Lifespan:** Each asset will have an assigned expected useful life. At the end of its lifespan, the asset should either be replaced, retired, or disposed of in accordance with the organization's disposal policy.

7. Asset Disposal

- **Retirement Process:** When an asset reaches the end of its lifecycle or is no longer needed, it must be retired through a formal process. This includes ensuring that all data and intellectual property are securely deleted and that the asset is disposed of in an environmentally responsible manner.
- **Data Wiping:** Before the disposal of any digital asset (e.g., computers, mobile devices, or storage media), all data must be wiped using industry-standard data erasure methods to prevent data recovery.
- **Disposal Methods:** Physical assets (e.g., old computers, printers) must be disposed of by certified e-waste management vendors or through donation, recycling, or sale as per organizational guidelines.
- **Documentation of Disposal:** All asset disposals must be documented, including the asset ID, date of disposal, method of disposal, and confirmation of data wiping (if applicable).

8. Asset Auditing and Compliance

- **Regular Audits:** The organization will conduct periodic audits of physical and digital assets to ensure that the inventory matches the records in the asset register. Any discrepancies will be investigated.
- **Compliance:** All assets and asset management processes will comply with applicable laws, regulations, and industry standards (e.g., IT Act 2000, GDPR, ISO 27001, etc.).
- **Internal and External Audits:** The organization may conduct internal audits and be subject to external audits to verify compliance with this policy and ensure that asset management practices are being followed.

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9. User Responsibilities

- **Asset Care and Protection:** Employees and stakeholders are responsible for the proper care, security, and maintenance of the assets assigned to them. They must follow the organization's security practices and report any loss, theft, or damage immediately to the IT or security team.
- **Asset Return:** When an employee leaves the organization or changes roles, they must return all assigned assets in good condition. A formal handover process will be followed, and all access to digital assets (e.g., accounts, passwords) will be revoked.

10. Policy Violations

- **Non-Compliance:** Any employee found to be in violation of the Asset Management Policy (e.g., mishandling assets, unauthorized disposal, misuse, or theft) will be subject to disciplinary action, which could include warnings, suspension, or termination, depending on the severity of the violation.
- **Reporting Violations:** Employees are encouraged to report any suspected policy violations or security breaches related to asset management through the company's whistleblower or incident reporting mechanisms.

11. Review and Updates

This Asset Management Policy will be reviewed annually or as necessary to ensure its relevance and effectiveness. Changes to the policy will be communicated to all employees, and training will be provided as needed to ensure compliance.